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APAC Industrial & Auto Sector Specialist Sales Commentary
Auto & EV • Equipment • Machinery • E&C • A&D

CH Auto: EU Policy Move; Hitachi; Toyota; US EE/MI Coverage Resumption; GEV at OW; Yaskawa 2Q First Glance; Songfa -7% Feedback

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US equities rebounded after 2x down days, shrugging off still-elevated energy costs (WTF modestly higher at $92) and bond yields, with growth/tech optimism back in the driving seat ahead of earnings season. 9 of 11 S&P sectors were higher led by Real Estate, Discretionary, Health Care & Financials while Telcos & Energy lagged. In tech, Amazon +3% rallied on talks to acquire AI startup Decart in a ~$7bn deal, and Microsoft +2% rose despite the CEO called for an "emergency brake" system on advanced AI models to prevent them going rogue. On the flip side, telcos were very weak with T-Mobile -13% on SpaceX competition fears, and HP -7% fell after IDC said PC shipments dropped 20% in the 3rd quarter (y/y). JPM pad this morning starting the day as better to sell on lighter volume with Japan closed for today; setting led by incremental profit takes in the AI space in both TW & KR.

Reutersreports the trade understanding could cut Chinese hybrid and plug-in hybrid exports to Europe by more than half over four years, though implementation details are undisclosed. With a final decision expected at the Oct 15–16 European Council summit, we see ~10% 27E earnings impact assuming a ~1mn export limit versus potential 2–3mn at 2030E. Most investor comments suggest this EU policy risk is now well flagged and largely in the price, with some looking to cover shorts once EU details are finalized. That said, there is little appetite to add China OEMs on the long side, as investors struggle to see positive mid-term growth in both domestic and overseas markets, which could lead to de-rating over time. In addition, a potential export rebate cut could drive further earnings downside risk (13% -> 9% export rebate cut could imply ~20% earnings downside in 2027E, based on Nick's simple calculation).

Julian Michelle (US EE/MI) analyst resumes coverage on 16 Electrical Equipment & Multi-Industry stocks was updated with a mildly positive sector stance but a "mid-cycle" framing; ratings changes include downgrading DD (also removed from the Analyst Focus List) and ITW from OW to N on concerns about decelerating short-cycle industrial demand into 2027, and moving to ratings on TT at OW and CARR at N, with TT and RRX as top picks; preferred exposures are names with higher 2027 organic sales growth (FPS, GEV, RRX, SPXC, TT), consistent "compounders" (PH), later-cycle end-market plays (EMR, HON), and self-help stories where consensus prices in little improvement (MMM, RRX). We are hosting him for Asian investors on Oct 20 (Tue) at 8am HKT. Register

Japan Extel voting is now open and it's very important for our research franchise; if you find our Japan team's work helpful, please give them ***** **FIVE STARS***** for their in-depth work, insights, global read-across, and on-the-ground research on key Japan stocks, including **Akira Kishimoto** (Japan Autos), **Junya Ayada** (Industrial Electricals, including Hitachi, MELCO, Panasonic, NEC and Fujitsu) and **Ryota Himeno** (Japan Logistics) *Please find full analyst roster + voting how-to in these links! Your support will be highly appreciated for us to continue our hard work & appreciate your feedback/commentary here for your support.*

- **China Auto:** EU policy move: A temporary ceasefire - Nick Lai
- **Hitachi (6501):** Long-term opportunities in data center business - Junya Ayada
- **Toyota Motor (7203):** Reorganization of Chinese joint ventures; sales network and platform integration synergies in focus moving forward - Akira Kishimoto
- **US RESUMPTION - EE/MI:**Pullback creates some modest mid-cycle catch-up potential; D/G DD, ITW to Nl Moving to ratings on TT at OW, CARR at N - Julian Mitchell

- **Yaskawa(6503 JP, Not covered) Earnings First Glance:** Headline In-line/ Above buyside expectation (Spec Take)
- **Key Inbounds -** Songfa (603268 ,-7%)
- **CATL 3Q25 Result Call (Oct 20, 8pm HKT)**: JPM will provide SI trnaslation of English Call (Register here or Ask your Sales representative)

Use the links below to jump straight to each section:

Detailed Highlights
Sector Key Newsflow
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Save the Dates: J.P. Morgan Industrials Events
Catalyst Calendar (Full Version)

Detailed Highlights

China Auto: EU policy move: A temporary ceasefire - Nick Lai

- Reuters **reports the EU and China reached a preliminary understanding where China would aim to halve HEV/PHEV exports to the EU over the next 4 years**, while the EU maintains access to critical materials (e.g., rare earths); the proposal will be discussed/finalized at the Oct 15–16 European Council summit. This shifts the EU's approach on China PHEVs from a TRQ (tariff-rate quota, i.e. standard 10% quota on export volume within the restrictive quota and punitive tariff above quota) concept to a bilateral VER (voluntary export restraint) framework, with HEVs now also in scope.
- **Key open items for Oct 15–16 are: (1) how the annual volume reduction target from 2027** is defined/measured, and (2) h**ow a minimum import price (MIP) mechanism** will be set to limit price competition.
- **Who will be most affected**: OEMs with the highest EU HEV/PHEV exposure should be most affected as exports could slow then be capped/cut over 2027–30, with EU officials estimating total reduced China HEV/PHEV volumes of "a few million" units. **BYD appears most exposed** (~30–40% of exports to the EU, incl. BEV/PHEV), **followed by Chery Auto** (~25%) **and SAIC**; others have limited direct EU HEV/PHEV exposure today (Geely skewing BEV since 2025 entry; Leapmotor via Stellantis JV; XPeng BEV with low starting volumes; Nio/Li Auto/Great Wall limited)
- **JPM View: We remain cautious into 2027 given policy uncertainty (domestic NEV subsidies, evolving EU policy, export VAT rebate risk) and earnings downside**. In a bear case—2027 domestic demand keeps falling, memory/input costs +20–25%, additional EU/UK tariffs or volume restrictions, and a 4% export VAT rebate cut from 2Q/2H27—**sector 2027 earnings could be flat to down vs 2026**. Until these policy uncertainties clear, **we prefer: (1) HDT over PV**—Sinotruk (OW), **(2) undemanding valuation**—Chery Auto, and **(3) longer-dated consolidation/"exit" beneficiaries**—Guangzhou Auto (turnaround more likely 2H27–2028).
- **Investor Feedback & Sales View:** General investor feedback suggests EU policy-related concerns are well flagged, with positioning light/well-shorted and valuations of key EU-exposed stocks undemanding (BYD 11.7X 27E P/E, Chery 4.6X). Investors are looking to the final EU quota-related decision as a near-term clearing event for EU-related concerns (JPM Nick Lai sees ~10% downside risk to 2027E numbers based on the EU proposal to cut ~1mn volumes for CH auto OEMs overall, from expected 2–3mn sales at 2030E in the EU) and may cover some shorts around the event; however, we still see lingering uncertainties, including an export rebate cut (13% existing -> 9% sometime next year, which could result in ~20% earnings downside based on Nick's simple calculation), implying another lag of earnings cut risk left (though some of this is already well flagged). That said, investors are expecting CH auto to trade range-bound post the EU decision clearing event until there is more clarity around the VAT rebate and extension of domestic policy support. Note that HF investors don't want to add further shorts at current levels, but remain negatively biased on the sector and may press shorts again on rebounds, while we don't sense much LO appetite to add here despite seemingly cheap valuations, as investors are concerned about potential CH auto de-rating given limited growth upside in both domestic and overseas markets.

Hitachi (6501): Long-term opportunities in data center business - Junya Ayada

- At Data Center World Asia (Sep 29–30), Hitachi's DC lead (KJ Joshi) framed DC as a "One Hitachi" growth vector (Strategic SIB BU) that can pull through Hitachi Energy, IT services and engineering, supporting medium/long-term growth in Hitachi Energy service revenue and HMAX. Strategy centers on (1) "Energy Parks" (GW-scale Energy-as-a-Service using hybrid onsite gen/solar/BESS, prefabricated modules, SPV financing and partner ecosystem) and (2) HMAX Data Center, a software platform that monitors/controls Green/Gray/White space (incl. AI-driven automated control loop and global NOCs delivering SaaS/managed O&M). We maintain OW and PT ¥6,500 (Dec-27) on Lumada-led service mix shift, Energy/rail/industry

growth opportunities, and capital-efficiency focus.

- **Investor Feedback:** Investor feedback on Hitachi (6501) has been the most constructive among Asian power equipment names, driven by undemanding valuation/positioning and room for upward earnings revisions led by the Energy segment, while Korean/Chinese transformers are seeing earnings downside risk driven by FX, ME delays (for Korea), and US EO impacts (for China). Noting some valuation debate among Asian investors: some argue Hitachi's valuation doesn't look as cheap and it lacks a new equity narrative for a re-rating, while foreign investors view valuation as comfortable given the stock trades at a discount to global peers (Hitachi 21.5X FY27E P/E, Siemens 23X, GEV 41X), has announced additional US capacity, and has an after-service business to support long-term stable growth.

Toyota Motor (7203): Reorganization of Chinese joint ventures; sales network and platform integration synergies in focus moving forward - Akira Kishimoto

- Toyota announced Oct 8 a new strategic alliance with China JV partners GAC and FAW, with GAC set to acquire FAW's 50% stake in FAW Toyota—bringing both Toyota China JVs under GAC. We see potential upside from faster NEV/SDV platform development for China, sales-network integration and other synergies as Toyota accelerates local execution. Toyota China remains challenging (Jan–Aug 2026 retail 928k, -19% y/y) and recent NEVs (bZ3X/bZ7) haven't sustained early momentum; we will watch how this JV reset supports the planned 2027 wholly-owned Shanghai plant and next-gen SDV rollout.
- **Related note from Nick Lai** - GAC (Guangzhou Auto; A critical step towards SOE reform and consolidation, OW, PT HK $5.7/RMB5.8)
- **Investor Feedback** on Toyota has been muted, with investors looking to see its RAV4 ramp-up become an earnings driver in 2HFY26, but taking a more "show me" stance and showing little appetite to pre-position. Investors remain most constructive on Honda on strong US data (+9% y/y during 2QFY26 in the US with lower incentives, while Toyota/Nissan/Mazda were relatively flat y/y; Subaru was +4% y/y but with somewhat higher incentives, though still less than Nissan/Mazda in terms of degree). We expect Toyota's RAV4 ramp to pick up meaningfully from Nov onward; however, investors want to see it materialize before playing Toyota for a better HoH recovery story, on top of mid-term ROE expansion story.

COVERAGE RESUMPTION - US EE/MI:Pullback creates some modest mid-cycle catch-up potential; D/G DD, ITW to Nl Moving to ratings on TT at OW, CARR at N - Julian Mitchell

- **Coverage on 16 Electrical Equipment & Multi-Industry stocks was updated with a mildly positive sector stance but a "mid-cycle" framing**: a recent pullback sets up modest catch-up potential and likely positive estimate-revision momentum into Q3 earnings, but mature B2B/industrial up-cycles, an AI cycle entering Year 4, and valuations that aren't cheap versus bond yields should cap multiple re-rating; ratings changes include downgrading DD (also removed from the Analyst Focus List) and ITW from OW to N on concerns about decelerating short-cycle industrial demand into 2027, and moving to ratings on TT at OW and CARR at N, with**TT and RRX as top picks**; **preferred exposures are names with higher 2027 organic sales growth (FPS, GEV, RRX, SPXC, TT), consistent "compounders" (PH), later-cycle end-market plays (EMR, HON), and self-help stories where consensus prices in little improvement (MMM, RRX)**, with an expectation for steady —not accelerating—growth ('27 median OSG ~6% after 7% in Q2'26).
- **Join Julian Mitchell on AMA on Oct 20 at 8am HKT**/ Oct 19 8pm ET, Register

Yaskawa(6503 JP, Not covered) Earnings First Glance: Headline In-line/ Above buyside expectation (Spec Take)

- **Yaskawa 2QFY** reported Rev of Y146.6bn (3% above Cons Y143bn), OP of Y13.6bn (2% above Cons of Y13.3bn, Beat on Buyside cons of Y12bn+). Orders at Y185.4bn (+13% QoQ, 16% above BBG cons & 5-10% above buyside cons of Y165-175bn)
- **OP beat was largely driven by Robotic** (Y5.1bn, 32% above Cons) **& System Eng** (Y1.6bn, 84% above Cons), while Motion control came below Cons (Y8.4bn OP, -14% below).
- **Changes to FY26 Guidance:** Rev Y580bn -> Y600bn, OP Y60bn -> Y57.5bn. New guidance is in-line with cons and slightly above the recent buyside cons OP of ~Y55bn.
- INITIAL FEEDBACK: Investors found the details decent though some investors said most incremental upside came from F/X (OP above general buyside expectations, orders above buyside expectations) & expect the stock to move up t+1 (Tuesday); however, questions center on the sustainability of the +ve price action, as new guidance is largely in-line with cons, leaving little room for beat in 2HFY26. Investors are keen to hear mgmt comments on ERP and order visibility related to China/Semi. During mgmt briefing, co commented on sustained AI/DC and semiconductor related demand seen in Q2FY26, while EPR

cost them roughly Y10bn Rev opportunity/JPY1.5 in OP, however, expects to normalize EPR co-wide within Q3 as the focus shifts to ramping output.

- **We have a new Japan FA/Machinery analyst joined us - Boqiong Wang** (ex-Nomura). Pls readh out for Boqiong's factual call note if interested.

Key Inbounds - Songfa (603268 ,-7%),

- **Guangdong Songfa (603268 CH, -7%):** Multiple inbounds on stiff correction; Flow-driven sector rotation/unwind in consensus long/shorts plus 3Q reset post-holidays (guidance 5%/10% rev/profit q/q vs prior low-/mid-teens Rev/profit q/q), with earnings more 4Q back-end loaded, prompting profit-taking amid near-term catalyst absence.Beatrice sees the selloff as overdone/flow-led and still expects strong y/y momentum (+200%/+355% YoY top/bottom line on adj. expectation), with next catalysts from LNGC/dual-fuel order wins and mix uplift in coming months, while acknowledging the timeline is uncertain. Read Beatrice Lam's latest on CH shipguliding

Sector Key Newsflow

- **Geely:** Announced entry into Canada on October 9, establishing local operations and a retail network ahead of first vehicle sales in 2027. (Reuters)
- **BYD:** A newly published design patent reveals its humanoid robot's appearance for service, education and industrial applications, but does not confirm performance or mass-production readiness. (CnEVPost)
- **China NEVs:** September passenger NEV retail sales fell 12% YoY to 1.141mn units but rose 14% MoM, according to preliminary CPCA figures. (CnEVPost)
- **Maersk** goes on shopping spree for ships in strategy U-Turn (FT): Maersk has made a strategic volte-face by pursuing an aggressive ship-buying program (*+ve read for commercial ship cycle: +ve for Korean/Chinese shipbuilders)*
- **Defence Cooperation:** South Korea and Japan reaffirmed coordination against North Korean nuclear and missile threats and agreed to advance cooperation in AI and unmanned systems. (Yonhap)
- **Riyadh Airport:** An attack on King Khalid International Airport killed at least 12 people and wounded more than 300 on October 10. (Reuters)
- **Ocean Molica:** US forces said they disabled the Panama-flagged cargo vessel's propulsion in the Gulf of Oman after blockade warnings were ignored, without harming its crew. (Reuters)
- **Tanker Rescue:** All 22 Indian crew members aboard MT GEM No. 2 were rescued safely following an incident off the UAE's Ras Al Khaimah coast. (Reuters)
- **Advantage Tankers:** Confirmed orders for six MR2, two Aframax/LR2 and two Suezmax tankers at Chinese and South Korean shipyards, all LNG dual-fuel ready. (iMarine)
- **Shadow Fleet:** The Netherlands proposed legislation allowing detention and inspection of false-flag vessels in its exclusive economic zone, prompting Russian threats of retaliation. (Bloomberg via gCaptain)
- **India Steel:** India released its draft steel policy for public consultation, targeting 604mn tonnes of capacity by 2047 and lower emissions intensity. (Reuters)
- **HD Hyundai Electric:** Is pursuing long-term transformer supply agreements for data centres, according to an October 9 industry report; signed contract terms were not disclosed. (Korea Economic Daily)
- **KEC International:** Secured ₹10.14bn of Indian transmission and distribution orders, including its first 765kV line for a pumped-storage plant, taking YTD order intake above ₹96bn. (CNBC-TV18)
- **Tatsuta Electric:** Plans further equipment investment at its Kyoto factory to increase AI data-centre leak-detection capacity to ~2.5x end-2026 levels by September 2027, following stronger-than-expected demand. (JX Advanced Metals)
- **Tata Power:** Villagers halted preliminary site investigations for its proposed 440MW nuclear project in Madhya Pradesh; officials said no land had been allotted and construction had not begun. (Indian Express)
- **Amazon:** Its planned data centre near Mumbai faces local opposition over environmental, power and water concerns; the company says it will not use cooling water or draw on residential power supplies. (Reuters)
- **Power Discounts:** New York Assembly lawmakers requested disclosure of discounted electricity supplied to data centres

through New York Power Authority programmes. (Times Union via Yahoo)

Full Research Links

Company Note:

- **Toyota Motor (7203 JP):** Reorganization of Chinese joint ventures; sales network and platform integration synergies in focus moving forward- Akira Kishimoto (Link)
- **Hitachi (6501 JP):** Long-term opportunities in data center business- Junya Ayada (Link)
- **NANKAI (9044 JP):** Takeaways from visit to Mt. Koya and small meeting with CEO- Ryota Himeno (Link)
- **Weichai Power - H/A(2338 HK/000338 CH):** Model update- Karen Li (Link)
- **Jiangsu Expressway - H/A(177 HK/600377 CH):** Quality yield in focus; 3Q26 preview- Jenny Qiu (Link)
- **Johnson Electric - H (179 HK):** 1H27 profit warning; lower estimates and PT- Beatrice Lam (Link)
- **Renault (RNO FP):** Q3'26 Preview: Early Look at the Quarter- Jose M Asumendi (Link)
- **Exosens (EXENS FP):** Increasing our estimates, good momentum in both divisions- David H Perry (Link)
- **Vincorion (V1NC GR):** Increasing our EPS estimates following guidance upgrade- David H Perry (Link)

Sector Note:

- **CH Auto Industry**: EU Policy Move: A Temporary Casefire - Nick Lai (Link)
- **India Industrials and Infrastrucutre:** Private Corporate Capex: On a Steady Growth Path- Atul Tiwari (Link)
- **AHRI Aug Data: Resi up +11% y/y (vs +20% y/y prior):** We see a neutral read to RHVAC OEMs/suppliers (CARR, TT, RRX); the recovery is occurring roughly in-line with our ests.- Julian Mitchell (Link)
- **Autos Valuation Comp Sheet:** Priced as of October 8, 2026- Rajat Gupta (Link)
- **US Electrical Equipment & Multi-Industry:** Pullback creates some modest mid-cycle catch-up potential; Downgrade DD, ITW to N; Moving to ratings on TT at OW, CARR at N- Julian Mitchell (Link)
- **Learnings from Earnings #1: Yaskawa orders strength persists:** We see = / + reads for the Motion Control / FA related names such as PH / ROK / RRX (and to a degree EMR).- Julian Mitchell (Link)
- **USDA World Ag Supply & Demand Estimates (WASDE):** US Major Crop Ending Stocks Above Consensus- Tami Zakaria (Link)
- **Global Autos Driver:** Global Autos Newsflow & Research- Jose M Asumendi (Link)

Save the Dates: J.P. Morgan Industrials Events

Analyst Meetings & JPM Webinars

Title	Speaker / Sector Coverage	Format	Date/Time (HKT)	Registration
Rishabh Gupta	India Industrial	Singapore; Hong Kong	Oct-5-7 (Mon-Wed); 8-9 (Thu-Fri)	Please Ask
Amyn Pirani	India Automobiles, Auto parts, Airlines and Leisure	Hong Kong	Oct-14-16 (Wed-Fri)	Please Ask
China Auto Market Developments: Assessing Strategic Implications for Japanese Automakers	Akira Kishimoto (Autos & Auto Parts), Nick Lai (Head of APAC Auto Research)	Virtual	Oct-15 (Thu) 10:30 HKT	Register Here
Sonny Lee	Korea Auto, Robotics, Battery and Utility	Singapore; Hong Kong	Oct-19-20 (Mon-Tue); 21-23 (Wed-Fri)	Please Ask
Akira Kishimoto + Nick Lai + Sonny Lee Group Lunch	APAC Autos	Singapore	Oct-20 (Tue) 12:00 HKT	Please Ask
Karen Li & Jenny Qiu	Asia Infrastructure, Industrial & Transport	KL; Singapore	Nov-3 (Tue); 4-6 (Wed-Fri)	Please Ask

Corporate Access

Title	Speaker	Format	Date/Time (HKT)	Registration
Kee Ming Group (KEEMING MK)	MD	Virtual (DC Multiplier Series)	Oct-14 (Wed) 10:30 HKT	Register Here
Magna International Inc (MGA US)	IR	Virtual	Nov-3 (Tue) 9:00 HKT	Register Here
Boustead Singapore (BOCS SP)	Deputy Group CEO, Head of Corp Marketing & IR	Virtual	Nov-12 (Thu) 10::00 AM	Register Here
Caterpillar Inc. (CAT US)	IR	Virtual	Nov-24 (Tue) 8:30 HKT	Register Here
Southwest Airlines Co (LUV US)	Head of IR	Virtual	Dec-1 (Tue) 9:00 HKT	Register Here

Conferences & Tours

Title	Format	Date/Time (HKT)
Asia Robotics & Automation Tour – Korea, CIIF China	Seoul, Shanghai	Oct-12-14 (Mon-Wed)
Japan Markets Forum (Save the date)	Four Seasons Hotel Tokyo Otemachi	Dec-01 (Tue)
Thailand Forum	Bangkok	Jan-21-22 (Thu-Fri)

Doko Shuzai (JPM Analyst-led coverage company meetings)

Date	Time	Language	Company	Host	Location	Registration
Wed 28 Oct	14:15-15:15 JST	J	CANON INC (7751 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 02 Nov	13:00-14:00 JST	English Only	MITSUB ELEC CORP (6503 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 02 Nov	14:30-15:30 JST	J / E	HITACHI LTD (6501 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 02 Nov	16:00-17:00 JST	J	NEC CORP (6701 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Wed 04 Nov	11:00-12:00 JST	J / E	PANASONIC HOLDIN (6752 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 09 Nov	11:00-12:15 JST	J	YAMAHA CORP (7951 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 09 Nov	13:00-14:00 JST	J	RICOH CO LTD (7752 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click

Catalyst Calendar (Full Version, all in HKT)

Date	Autos & EVs	Electric & Industrial Equipment	Macro
10/12			
10/13	Ronbay EGM (10:00)	SHENZHEN INOVA-A EGM (10:45)	US - Existing Home Sales (22:00)
10/14		Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd Q2	CH - PPI (09:30) CH - CPI (09:30)
10/15	ARB corp AGM (06:30)		JN - Core Machine Orders (07:50) JN - Industrial Production (12:30) UK - Manufacturing Production (14:00) EC - Industrial Production SA (17:00)
10/16	Tuopu EGM (15:00)	SCHNEIDER ELECTR Q3 Sales	US - Industrial Production (21:15) US - Capacity Utilization (21:15)

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